

BBA Chapter 3 — Aramaic Syllabification Drill

Open/Closed Syllables · Dagesh Forte · Guttural Quiescence · Accent

For each word: (1) divide into syllables using |, (2) label each syllable O (open) or C (closed), (3) mark stressed syllable with ´, (4) note any special features (Dagesh Forte, quiescence, etc.).

Part A — Basic Division (1–8)

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
1	מַלְכָּא	malkā´				
2	אֵלְהָא	´elāhā´				
3	בֵּית	bêt				
4	מַלְכִין	malkîn				
5	כְּתָב	ketab				
6	אֲבוּהִי	´ābūhî				
7	יְהוּד	yəhûd				
8	שְׁמַיָּא	šəmayyā´				

Part A — Basic Division (1–8) — Answer Key

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
1	מַלְכָּא	malkā'				
✓	מַלְכָּא	malkā'	■■■ ■■■■	C · C	'■■■■	Final ■ quiescent (det. state)
2	אַלְהָא	'ēlāhā'				
✓	אַלְהָא	'ēlāhā'	■ ■■ ■■■	O · O · C	'■■■	Hateph seghol; final ■ quiescent
3	בֵּית	bêt				
✓	בֵּית	bêt	■■■■■	C	'■■■■■	Waw is mater for Tsere
4	מַלְכִּין	malkîn				
✓	מַלְכִּין	malkîn	■■■ ■■■■	C · C	'■■■■	Yod is mater for Hireq Gadol
5	כְּתָב	ketab				
✓	כְּתָב	ketab	■■■ ■■■	O · C	'■■■	Opening sheva = vocal
6	אַבוּהִי	'ābûhî				
✓	אַבוּהִי	'ābûhî	■ ■■■ ■■■	O · O · O	'■■■	Hateph Patach; Waw = Shuruq; Yod =
7	יְהוּד	yehûd				
✓	יְהוּד	yehûd	■ ■■■■	O · C	'■■■■	Opening sheva = vocal; Waw = Shuruq
8	שְׁמַיָּא	šəmayyā'				
✓	שְׁמַיָּא	šəmayyā'	■■■ ■■■ ■■■	O · C · C	'■■■	Dagesh Forte in Yod = doubled

Part B — Dagesh Forte Doubling (9–12)

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
9	שַׁבָּת	šabbat				
10	כַּסְסָּדִים	kaśśədîm				
11	הַדְּבָרִין	haddabrîn				
12	מִנְיָ	minnay				

Part B — Dagesh Forte Doubling (9–12) — Answer Key

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
9	שַׁבַּת	šabbat				
✓	שַׁבַּת	šabbat	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	C · C	ʾ ■ ■ ■ ■	Dagesh Forte in Beth
10	כְּסָדִים	kaššəḏīm				
✓	כְּסָדִים	kaššəḏīm	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	C · C	ʾ ■ ■ ■ ■	Dagesh Forte in Samech
11	הַדְּבָרִין	haddabrîn				
✓	הַדְּבָרִין	haddabrîn	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	C · C · C	ʾ ■ ■ ■ ■	Dagesh Forte in Dalet
12	מִנִּי	minnay				
✓	מִנִּי	minnay	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	C · O	ʾ ■ ■ ■	Dagesh Forte in Nun (assimilation)

Part C — Guttural and Quiescence Features (13–16)

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
13	אָמַר	ʾāmar				
14	חֲכִים	ḥakkīm				
15	עַם	ʿim				
16	מִלְאָךְ	malʾak				

Part C — Guttural and Quiescence Features (13–16) — Answer Key

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
13	אָמַר	ʾāmar				
✓	אָמַר	ʾāmar	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	O · C	ʾ ■ ■ ■ ■	Long Qamets in open syllable; Aleph
14	חֲכִים	ḥakkīm				
✓	חֲכִים	ḥakkīm	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	C · C	ʾ ■ ■ ■ ■	Dagesh Forte in Kaph; Cheth = guttural
15	עַם	ʿim				
✓	עַם	ʿim	■ ■ ■	C	ʾ ■ ■ ■	Ayin = guttural; short Hireq in closed
16	מִלְאָךְ	malʾak				
✓	מִלְאָךְ	malʾak	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	C · C	ʾ ■ ■ ■ ■	Aleph in second syllable; takes Patach

Part D — Accent and Vowel Reduction (17–20)

Part D — Accent and Vowel Reduction (17–20) — Answer Key

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
17	נְבוּכַדְנֶצָר׀ nəḇûḵadnešsar					
✓	נְבוּכַדְנֶצָר׀ nəḇûḵadnešsar	■ ■ . ■ ■ ■ . ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ C O C : C C	'■■■	Opening vocal sheva; Dagesh Forte in		
18	מַלְכוּתָא malkûtā'					
✓	מַלְכוּתָא malkûtā'	■ ■ ■ . ■ ■ ■ . ■ ■ ■	C-O-C	'■■■	Waw = Shuruq; final ■ quiescent	
19	בְיֹם bēyôm					
✓	בְיֹם bēyôm	■ ■ ■ . ■ ■ ■ ■	O-C	'■■■■	Prefix ■■■ = vocal sheva; Waw =	
20	לְמַלְכָא ləmalkā'					
✓	לְמַלְכָא ləmalkā'	■ ■ . ■ ■ ■ . ■ ■ ■ ■	O-C-C	'■■■■	Prefix ■■ = vocal sheva; propretonic ■■	